

Waris Ahmad Faizi

Work Address: 555 McBryde Hall, Virginia Tech,
225 Stanger St. Blacksburg, VA 24061

Email: warisahmad@vt.edu
Phone Number: +1 (540) 998 9407

Education:

Ph.D., Sociology, Virginia Tech Graduate School, [2024 – in progress]

M.A., Sociology, American University of Central Asia, 2023

M.A., Economics, Organization for Security and Cooperation in Europe (OSCE) Academy, 2020

B.A., Economics, Kabul University, 2015

Areas of Research Interest:

- Economic Sociology
- Digital Sociology
- Labor, Work, and Organizations
- Quantitative Methods
- Computational Social Science

Academic/Professional Experience:

2025 –	Graduate Teaching Assistant, Department of Sociology, Virginia Tech • SOC 1004: Introductory Sociology • SOC 3204: Social Research Methods • AFST 1814: Intro to African Studies • AFST 4354: Topics in Africana Studies
Summer 2025	Graduate Research Assistant, Department of Sociology, Virginia Tech
2024 - 2025	Graduate Teaching Assistant, Department of Sociology, Virginia Tech • SOC 1004: Introductory Sociology • SOC 3204: Social Research Methods • AFST 1814: Intro to African Studies • AFST 4354: Topics in Africana Studies
2022 – 2023	Research Intern, Vice President Office for Academic Affairs, American University of Central Asia
2021	Research Fellow, Central Asia Program, George Washington University
2021	Research Intern, Central for Research and Graduate Education (CRGE), Kazakh-German University (DKU)
2021	Research Consultant, The World Bank Project, Pearl Horizon Consulting
2019 – 2021	Lecturer/Instructor, Gawharshad University
2019 – 2021	Lecturer/Instructor, Tolo-e-Aftab Institute of Higher Education
2016 – 2018	Lecturer/Instructor, Fanoos Institute of Higher Education
2016 – 2021	Lecturer/Instructor, Sayed Jamaluddin Afghan Institute of Higher Education

Awards and Honors:

- Dean's Graduate Scholar in the College of Liberal Arts and Human Sciences, Virginia Tech, 2026
 - CLAHS (College of Liberal Arts and Human Sciences) Fellowship Award, Virginia Tech, 2026
- Center for Humanities Graduate Student Fellowship, Virginia Tech, 2026
- Patricia and John Edwards Fellowship Award, Virginia Tech, 2025
- Student Initiative Development Program Fund, Center for Civic Engagement, American University of Central Asia, Bishkek, 2023

- Erasmus+ Exchange Scholarship, Otto-von-Guericke-University (OVGU), Germany, 2022
- Central Asia Program's Research Fellowship, George Washington University, 2021
- MA Sociology Program Full Scholarship, American University of Central Asia, 2021
- MA Economics Program Full Scholarship, OSCE Academy, 2019

Publications:

Faizi, Waris Ahmad. 2021. The Future of the CASA-1000 Electric Megaproject in the Context of the New Afghanistan. *George Washington University*. <https://centralasiaprogram.org/archive/central-asia-research-paper/the-future-of-the-casa-1000-electric-megaproject-in-the-context-of-the-new-afghanistan/>

Faizi, Waris Ahmad. 2020. Impact of Development Projects on Jobs Creation in Afghanistan (2016 – 2019). *OSCE Academy*. <https://mt.osce-academy.kg/handle/123456789/430>

Manuscripts Under Review

Calasanti, Toni, Waris Ahmad Faizi, and Neal King. 2026. "Age Relations and Intersections." *Sociology Compass*. (Under Review).

Faizi, Waris Ahmad, Dayoung Kim, Can Dogan, Sohyun Park, and Junghwan Kim. 2026. "Mapping Workforce Reskilling Urgency in the Age of AI: Occupational and Geographic Patterns Across the United States." *Telematics and Informatics*. (Revise and Resubmit).

Roos, J. Micah, Waris Ahmad Faizi, and Shih-Hao Lin. 2026. "Confidence in Science and Political Institutions, 2010-2024: Four Distinct Patterns of Polarization." *Socius: Sociological Research for a Dynamic World*. (Manuscript ready to be submitted soon).

Works in Progress:

Roos, J. Micah, Waris Ahmad Faizi, and Shih-Hao Lin. 2026. "Item Level Bias in the NSF-sponsored Science Knowledge Scale 2006-2024."

Faizi, Waris Ahmad. 2026. "The Moral Economies of Influencer Culture: Visibility, Value, and Intersectional Precarity."

Faizi, Waris Ahmad. 2026. "Divergent Value Trajectories: Cultural and Economic Liberalization in the United States, 2004–2024"

Faizi, Waris Ahmad. 2026. "Platform Labor, Identity, and Inequality: A Systematic Review of Gig Work Through an Intersectional Lens."

Faizi, Waris Ahmad. 2026. "Social Capital and the Geography of Opportunity: Economic Connectedness, Bias, and Mobility in the United States."

Faizi, Waris Ahmad. 2026. "Pricing Care Labor: A Computational Systematic Review of How Care Work is Economically and Socially Devalued."

Conference Presentations:

Faizi, Waris Ahmad. 2026. "Social Capital and the Geography of Opportunity: Economic Connectedness, Bias, and Mobility in the United States" *Southern Sociological Society (SSS) 2026 Annual Meeting*. Jacksonville, FL. April 8-11, 2026.

Faizi, Waris Ahmad. 2026. "Divergent Value Trajectories: Cultural and Economic Liberalization in the United States, 2004–2024." *42nd Annual GPSS Research Symposium and Exposition, Virginia Tech, Blacksburg, VA*. March 25, 2026.

Faizi, Waris Ahmad. 2026. "The Moral Economies of Influencer Culture: Visibility, Value, and Intersectional Precarity." *Eastern Sociological Society, 96th Annual Meeting*. Washington, DC. March 5-8, 2026.

Faizi, Waris Ahmad. 2025. "Redistribution Gap: Class, Race and Political Ideology in Shaping Attitudes Toward Inequality." *Association for Humanist Sociology, 49th Annual Meeting*. Columbus, Ohio, November 5-9, 2025.

Faizi, Waris Ahmad. 2025. "Economic Precarity, Quality of Work Life, and Social Trust: An Empirical Study of the U.S. Workforce (2004 – 2024)." *Society for the Study of Social Problems (SSSP) 2025 Annual Meeting*. Chicago, Illinois, August 8-10, 2025.

Faizi, Waris Ahmad. 2025. "Public, Private, or Personal: Comparative Impacts of Government, Private, and Self-Employment on Job and Financial Satisfaction in the United States." *The Canadian Association for Work and Labour Studies (CAWLS)*. Hamilton, Ontario, May 28-30, 2025.

Faizi, Waris Ahmad. 2025. "Digital Transformation and Work Paradigm's Shift: Remote Work's Impact on Social Networks and Integration, Well-being, and Economic Stability in the United States". *Southern Sociological Society (SSS) 2025 Annual Meeting*. Charlotte, North Carolina. April 9-12, 2025.

Faizi, Waris Ahmad. 2016. Efficacy of Human Skills Development as a source of Regional Competitive Advantage and Economic Development in Afghanistan. *South Asian Economics Students' Meet (SAESM)*. Colombo, April, 2016.

Faizi, Waris Ahmad. 2014. Afghan Carpets' Export Situation; Challenges and Opportunities. *South Asian Economics Students' Meet (SAESM)*. Thimphu, Dec, 2014.

Statistical Software Proficiency (Teaching & Research):

- R, Python, Stata, SPSS, and JMP.

Pedagogy Certification:

Future Professoriate/Global Perspectives Program (GPP), Virginia Tech (Fall 2025 – Spring 2026)

- *Preparing Future Professoriate* (3 credits), Fall 2025
- *Contemporary Pedagogy* (3 credits), Spring 2026
- *Higher Education 360* (3 credits), Spring 2026

Training, Workshops, and Events:

- Social Network Analysis, University of California, Davis, Online Course (Coursera), 2026
- Causal Inference, Columbia University, Online Course (Coursera), 2026
- Social and Economic Networks: Models and Analysis, Stanford University, Online Course (Coursera), 2026
- Narrative Economics, Yale University, Online Course (Coursera), 2026
- Best Practices for Mentorship in Teaching, Virginia Tech, 2026
- Introduction to Geospatial Mapping and ArcGIS Online, Virginia Tech, 2026
- Manage Your Scholarly Identity Challenge Course, Virginia Tech, 2026
- Connect to ARC Systems with VSCode, Virginia Tech, 2026
- Advanced Research Computing Roadmap, Virginia Tech, 2026
- The Joyful Journey: Graduate Student and Postdoctoral Scholar Professional Development Series, Center for the Integration of Research, Teaching, and Learning (CIRTL), Spring 2026
- Day for Data, AI & Analytics Symposium, November 3, 2025, Center for the Arts, Virginia Tech
- Datapalooza 2025: Truth and Accountability in the Age of AI, November 14, 2025, University of Virginia (UVA) School of Data Science
- Summer Institute for Undergraduate Education, May 2025, Virginia Tech
- Introduction to LaTeX with Overleaf, February 2025, Virginia Tech
- Introduction to Database Management and SQL, February 2025, Virginia Tech

- Preparing for the Academic Job Market Workshop Series (Virtual), September–October 2025, University of North Carolina at Chapel Hill
- Social & Behavioral Research (CITI Basic Course), November 2024
- Graduate Teaching Assistant (GTA) Workshop Series, August–October 2024, Virginia Tech
- Courses in Python and R, 2021–2025, LinkedIn Learning and DataCamp

University Service:

2023 Career Development Mentor/Trainer, American University of Central Asia

Professional Affiliations and Membership:

- American Sociological Association (ASA)
- Southern Sociological Society (SSS)
- Eastern Sociological Society (ESS)
- Society for the Study of Social Problems (SSSP)
- Association for Humanist Sociology (AHS)
- Pacific Sociological Association (PSA)
- Dataism Laboratory for Quantitative Finance (DLQF), Virginia Tech
- Center for Humanities (CfH), Virginia Tech

References:

Toni Calasanti, PhD, FGSA
Professor of Sociology
Director of Graduate Studies
Virginia Tech
648 McBryde Hall (0137)
Blacksburg, VA 24061
(540) 231-8961
she/her/hers
toni@vt.edu

Micah Roos, PhD
Associate Professor of Sociology
Virginia Tech
McBryde Hall
225 Stanger Street
Blacksburg, VA 24061
jmroos@vt.edu

P.S. Polanah, PhD
Associate Professor
Africana Studies/Sociology Dept.
Virginia Tech
670 McBryde Hall, 225 Stanger Street.
Blacksburg, VA 24061
+1 (540) 231 5650
ppolanah@vt.edu